

THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

PMGM7045

Curating a career: the implications of a 100-year-life

GENERAL INFORMATION
Instructor: Adj Asst Prof. David Dodwell Department: Management and Strategy Email: ddodwell@hku.hk Office: Phone: 6166 9697 Consultation time: By appointment Tutor: Professor Dodwell, supported as necessary by guest lecturers drawn from business Learning materials: No designated textbooks. Reading materials will be assigned.
COURSE DESCRIPTION
This course addresses the challenges of shaping and managing a career in the context of radical demographic and technological change: how are longer and healthier lives fundamentally reshaping historically conventional careers? How is swiftly-changing technology altering optimal vocational choices and future skills needs? How is “working from home” and “gig” working impacting career and skills development? These and multiple other career management topics, including career stages/paths, human and social capital, employment relationships, and work-life balance will be addressed. The course will aim to equip students to manage their careers and skills development with more confidence and improved effectiveness.
COURSE OBJECTIVES
By the end of the course, students should be able to: CO1. Examine career management problems critically CO2. Recognise the demographic changes that are radically altering the structure of working lives CO3. Analyse more effectively future skills needs CO4. Ensure financial security while managing more complex career tracks CO5. Recognise the serendipitous forces impacting career tracks, and how to manage the risks and opportunities that arise CO5. Optimise wellness and work-life balance to ensure a long and healthy working life
Programme Learning Outcomes

PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the programme discipline			
PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge			
PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership			
PLO4: Developing global outlook			
PLO5: Mastering communication skills			
COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES			
Course Learning Outcomes			Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes
CLO1. Demonstrate critical thinking when presented with career management problems and express their views and opinions on career management issues in an articulate way			PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
CLO2. Identify the solutions for key challenges and obstacles in an employee’s career development			PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
CLO3. Conduct topic and case analyses to apply theoretical concepts			PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
CLO4. Demonstrate effective communication and presentation skills			PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
CLO5. Cultivate career management skills to navigate one’s career			PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES			
Course Teaching and Learning Activities		Expected Hour	Study Load (% of study)
T&L1. Interactive and guest lectures		30	25%
T&L2. Group presentation and report		20	17%
T&L3. Individual assignments		40	33%
T&L4. Lecture preparation & self-study		30	25%
Total		120	100%
Assessment Methods	Brief Description	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. Attendance	Attendance	10%	CLO1, 2, 5
A2. Quality of Class participation	Effort and quality	10%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
A3. A group project	Team collaboration	20%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
A4. Two individual essays	Effort and quality	20 + 20%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
A5. Final test	Effort and Quality	20%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5
	Total	100%	
STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT			
Course Grade Descriptors			

A+, A, A-	•Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge •Handling questions professionally •High participation in discussions •Present arguments that have an element of originality •Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the exams with very good analytical and problem solving skills •Excellent performance in assignments
B+, B, B-	•Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge •Handling questions in a logical way •Good participation in discussions •Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook •Achieve a standard of good performance in the exams with good analytical and problem solving skills •Good performance in assignments
C+, C, C-	•Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved •Fairly address questions as set •Some participation in discussions •Present arguments in a well-structure manner •Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the exams with acceptable analytical and problem solving skills •Acceptable performance in assignments
D+, D	•Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved •Barely address questions as set •Minimal or no participation in discussions •Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner •Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the exams with barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills •Marginally acceptable performance in assignments
F	•Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved •Unable or unwilling to handle questions •Minimal or no participation in discussions •Present arguments poorly •Do not meet a standard of passing the exams and do not have adequate analytical and problem solving skills •Poor performance in assignments
Assessment Rubrics for Participation	
A+, A, A-	•High participation in discussions •Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge •Handling questions professionally •Present arguments that have an element of originality •Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
B+, B, B-	•Good participation in discussions •Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge •Handling questions in a logical way •Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook •Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
C+, C, C-	•Some participation in discussions •Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved •Fairly address questions as set •Present arguments in a well-structured manner

	•Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
D+, D	•Minimal or no participation in discussions •Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved •Barely address questions as set •Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner •Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
F	•Minimal or no participation in discussions •Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved •Unable or unwilling to handle questions •Present arguments poorly •Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late)

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

1	The Impact of a 100-year life on Careers: the death of the 3-stage life The demographic likelihood is that any Business School student today will live beyond 100 years old and in good health until the last three or four years. This reality has extinguished traditional ideas of the “three-stage” life that has shaped human careers through hundreds of years past. It has also forced radical new thinking about life plans in the decades after 60. This opening lecture sets out this new reality, and lays the ground for thinking about how to navigate a career likely to span the next seven decades.
2	Jobs for life Once upon a time, a bright student that studied hard and successfully for the first two decades of his or her life might aspire to graduate to a junior position in a large and successful company or institution. For the next four decades, life would be spent being gradually promoted up to the company’s senior ranks, followed by retirement on an ample pension for life’s few remaining years. Today, for most graduates, no such future lies ahead. The likelihood is for life into your seventies to span multiple careers, most of them curated by yourself, and punctuated by breaks to refresh, to reskill, and perhaps to raise a family. What are the implications of this life-revolution?
3	Jobs for the future It is often said that most of the jobs that will be opening up 20 years from now do not yet exist. What will these “jobs of the future” look like, and how do you equip yourself with the skills needed to fill them?
4	Unique career challenges for women The fact that women today continue to carry the main burden of bearing children and raising a family has a profound historic impact on women’s career plans and prospects. Traditional ideas that a career normally ends at the age of 60 still severely constrains women’s ability to rebuild momentum in a career disrupted by child-bearing. But the 100-year-life, which opens up careers into your seventies, transforms women’s career prospects. How can women optimize the opportunities arising from this transformation, and how are companies adjusting?
5	Ageism and the concept of retirement Ageism in the workplace remains a deep and often unrecognized barrier, stunting peoples’ careers and depriving companies of skills and potential from which they would benefit. This lecture examines the price many companies pay for neglecting the potential contribution of

	older workers, and the potential advantages of developing a “five-generation” workforce with flexible retirement rules. It illustrates the value to society of enabling older working people to continue contributing, and retaining self-reliance, instead of being forced into pension-funded dependency.
6	The impact of AI and new technologies Adjusting to take the greatest advantage of new technologies is always one of the greatest workplace challenges. How are new technologies going to effect our futures? In particular, how are technological changes linked with Artificial Intelligence altering (and perhaps threatening) the roles we humans will play in the workplace. This lecture strives to peer into the future, to explore the most likely changes, and to examine how we humans can most meaningfully respond.
7	Managing the money: maintaining financial security through a 100-year life Curating a complex and diverse career into the future may involve work-breaks and periods devoted to reskilling. This raises new challenges concerning how to ensure your (and your family’s) financial security. This lecture will examine the financial implications of a 100-year life, whether on earning, spending, saving or investing, or on the critical role of health and wellness.
8	The Job Interview challenge: how to get noticed As an increasing number of companies rely on AI tools to filter applicants for new jobs, and even internal promotions or career developments, so job applicants need to master the art of drafting CVs, and managing virtual interviews. This lecture will explore how you set about getting noticed.
9	The impact of Serendipity What is serendipity? However carefully you try to plan your future, it is likely to be serendipitous forces or events that determine whether – and how far – you succeed. Why is it such an important force on your career, both personally, and for companies? Examples will be explored and discussed.
10	Course review and discussion, and final test
MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE	
Students are welcome to give feedback/suggestions on this course	
COURSE POLICIES (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)	
Maintaining an orderly and a fair environment is vital for effective learning. Hence, disruptive academic behaviors are unacceptable. The university regulations on academic dishonesty, including cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, falsifying academic records, and any act designed to avoid participating honestly in the assessment process, will be strictly enforced. In addition, any such dishonest acts will result in an F grade.	
ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)	
Assignments will be given in class and online. No late assignment will be accepted. Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded to Moodle.	

